Nehru gave to them was, ‘Wherever they go, they serve humanity,’ which left them all reeling in speechless stupour.[14]

When the Bar Council of India (‘BCI’) passed a resolution on 22 December 2019 urging the lawyers, bar associations, state bar councils and students’ associations of all law colleges to ensure that law and order is maintained throughout the country, nearly a thousand lawyers from across the country immediately distanced themselves from its statement on the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 and the National Register of Citizens (NRC). This is because it had chosen to thoughtlessly add the words of its chairman Manan Kumar Mishra,

> The Leaders of the Bar and young students are requested to take active role in diffusing the disturbances and violence in the country: We are to convince the people and the illiterate ignorant mass, who are being misled by some so-called leaders [that] the matter with regard to Citizenship Amendment Act is under consideration of our Supreme Court, therefore everyone should await the decision of apex court.

This led N. Manoj Kumar, the vice-chairman of the executive committee of the BCI to dissent vehemently in these terms:

> The protests against CAA and NRC are the attempt of the Indian citizens to save their Constitution from being trampled upon by an authoritarian regime on the strength of their brute majority in the Legislature. Being the real torch bearers of the constitution, it is the duty of every self-esteemed lawyer to lead the struggle to defend the constitution.

The dissent was then signed by close to 1,000 lawyers who wished to make it emphatically clear ‘that the BCI has not spoken for the Bar’. Indeed, it went on to remark that

> it is amiss that the BCI, a body which is supposed to stand up for the Bar, did not deem it fit to express solidarity with advocates such as Mr. Mohd. Shoaib who has been detained in Lucknow or the hundreds of advocates fighting across the country to uphold the rights of citizens as recognised by the constitution.[15]

Yet, when protests broke out in the southern city of Bangalore, one of the banners being proudly waved in the throng featured none other than Bhagat Singh. By April 2022, however, the worsening situation saw homes of the